RR-H-40a
July 28, 1966

SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. RR-H-0040 (GSA-FSS)
September 8, 1964

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

# HANDCART, GROCERY, (NESTING)

*This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.*

## 1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

**1.1 Scope.** This specification covers metal grocery type handcarts (shopping carts).

**1.2 Classification.**

**1.2.1** *Types.* Handcarts covered by this specification shall be furnished in the following types, as specified (see 6.2).

I—With baby seat and lower basket.

II—With baby seat and lower tray.

III—With lower basket.

IV—With lower tray.

V—With baby seat.

VI—Without baby seat, lower basket or tray.

**1.2.2** *Sizes.* Handcarts covered by this specification shall be furnished in the following large, upper basket sizes, as specified (see 6.2):

| | |
|---|---|
| 5000 cubic inches | 8000 cubic inches |
| 6000 cubic inches | 9000 cubic inches |
| 7000 cubic inches | 10,000 cubic inches |

## 2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

**2.1** The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

*Federal Specifications*:

PPP-B-585—Boxes, Wood, Wirebound.

PPP-B-591—Boxes, Fiberboard, Wood-Cleated.

PPP-B-601—Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.

PPP-B-621—Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.

PPP-B-640—Boxes, Fiberboard, Corrugated, Triple-Wall.

PPP-B-650—Box, Fiberboard Special Purpose (Records Retiring).

*Federal Standards*:

Fed. Std. No. 66—Steel: Chemical Composition and Hardenability.

Fed. Std. No. 123—Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D. C. 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D. C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Wash.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

*Military Specification*:

MIL-P-116—Preservaton, Methods of.

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*Military Standards*:

MIL-STD-105—Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

MIL-STD-129—Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

## 3. REQUIREMENTS

**3.1 Material.**

**3.1.1** *Carbon steel.* Steel wire, strip and tubing shall conform to C1010 to C1020 of Fed. Std. No. 66.

**3.1.2** *Plastic.* Plastic for handle, seat and other components shall be acetal, acrylic, cellulose acetate butyrate, nylon, polypropylene, butadiene styrene, or polystyrene, at the manufacturer's option.

**3.2 Construction.**

**3.2.1** *Basket.* The upper basket shall be rectangular in shape, have a hinged rear gate, closely woven wire mesh sides and bottom, with reinforcements conforming to 3.1.1. When specified (see 6.2), baskets shall be furnished with plastic, rubber, or metal bumpers.

**3.2.2** *Supporting structure.* The supporting structure shall be tubular steel, steel strip or a combination thereof conforming to 3.1.1.

**3.2.3** *Seat.* The baby seat shall be of the folding variety to permit nesting or increasing capacity. A leg-hole closure device shall be provided and may be of plastic as specified in 3.1.2. The device shall operate in such a way as to prevent moisture from running back into the basket when leg-holes are closed.

**3.2.4** *Wheels.* Wheels shall be heavy duty ball or roller bearing, either sealed lubricant or grease type, with nonmarring plastic, rubber or synthetic rubber tread at the manufacturer's option. Minimum diameter of wheels shall be 4 inches for front and 5 inches for rear.

**3.2.5** *Casters.* Casters shall be heavy duty ball or roller bearing sealed lubricant type. Front casters shall be swivel type. Rear caster shall be of the rigid type, except that when specified (see 6.2), swivel type casters may be furnished.

**3.2.6** *Welding.* All spot welds shall be sound and free of porosity, expulsion, or surface burning and shall show good penetration in each welded part. Fusion welding or brazing shall be in accordance with established welding procedures to insure welds of full strength. Welds shall be smooth, free from cracks, surface porosity, and undercutting.

**3.3 Finish** The entire basket and supporting structure shall be chromium plated in accordance with commercial practice.

**3.4 Performance.** Handcarts shall not overturn or deform when tested in accordance with 4.4.2.

**3.5 Identification marking.** Handcarts shall be marked in a plain and permanent manner with the manufacturer's name or trademark of such known character that the source of manufacture may be readily determined.

**3.6 Personalized marking.** When required (see 6.2), personalized markings shall be as specified.

**3.7 Workmanship.** Handcarts shall be free from sharp edges, projections, and defects which might impair its serviceability, appearance, or endanger the health or safety of users.

## 4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

**4.1 Responsibility for inspection.** Unless otherwise specified in the contract or pur-



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chase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

**4.2 Sampling.**

4.2.1 *Lot.* Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), a lot shall consist of each type and size of handcarts offered for delivery at the same time.

4.2.2 *Visual and workmanship of end item.* Handcarts shall be examined for these characteristics in accordance with level S-4 in MIL-STD-105.

4.2.3 *Sampling for tests.* Samples for tests shall be in accordance with level S-2 in MIL-STD-105.

**4.3 Inspection.**

4.3.1 *End item.* Handcarts shall be examined for defects listed in table I. The acceptable quality levels (AQL's) for defects listed in table I shall be 2.5 percent defective for major defects and 4.0 percent defective for minor defects.

TABLE I. *Classification of defects, end item*

| Defects | Major | Minor |
|---|---|---|
| Type and size not as specified | X | |
| Sharp edges or projections | X | |
| Parts disengaged | X | |
| Surfaces not plated | X | |
| Casters fail to swivel | X | |
| Wheels and casters fail to bear evenly on a flat surface | X | |
| Weld missing, fractured, or incomplete fusion | X | |
| Porosity or undercut in welds | | X |
| Burn holes or pits | | X |

4.3.2 *Inspection of preparation for delivery requirements.* An inspection shall be made to determine that the packaging, packing, and marking requirements comply with section 5. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table II. For examination of contents, the sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery selected just prior to the closing operations. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. Defects of closure listed shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be II with an AQL of 4.0 defects per hundred units.

TABLE II. *Classification of preparation for delivery defects*

| Examine | Defects |
|---|---|
| Markings (exterior and interior) | Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, sequence, or method of application. |
| Materials | Any component missing or damaged. |
| Workmanship | Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, inadequate stapling. |
| | Bulging or distortion of container. |

**4.4 Tests.**

4.4.1 *Acceptance.* The AQL shall be 1 percent in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.4.2 *Stability.* Handcarts shall be tested for stability and operation by loading it four times its actual weight. The loaded handcart shall be wheeled about on a smooth level floor by gradually applying a force in a horizontal direction against the handle and then the upper basket.

## 5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

**5.1 Packaging.** Packaging shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 *Level A.* The handcarts shall be packaged in accordance with method III of MIL-P-116.

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5.1.2 *Level B.* The handcarts shall be packaged as specified in 5.1.1.

5.1.3 *Level C.* The handcarts shall be packaged in accordance with the supplier's commercial practice.

5.2 **Packing.** Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 *Level A.* Handcarts of like description nested and secured shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-585, class 3; PPP-B-591, class II; PPP-B-601, overseas type; PPP-B-621, class 2; PPP-B-640, class 2, grade A; or in a crate conforming to PPP-B-650. The boxes and crate shall be closed and strapped in accordance with the applicable specification or appendix thereto. When the gross weight of the boxes exceeds 250 pounds, skids shall be provided in accordance with PPP-B-601.

5.2.2 *Level B.* Handcarts of like description nested and secured shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-585, class 1; PPP-B-591, class 1; PPP-B-601, domestic type; or PPP-B-640, class 2, grade A. The boxes shall be closed in accordance with the applicable specification or appendix thereto. When the gross weight exceeds 250 pounds, skids shall be provided in accordance with PPP-B-601. When specified (see 6.2), handcarts of like description shall be prepared for shipment, nested, and secured.

5.2.3 *Level C.* The handcarts shall be packed to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery to destination at the lowest rates in containers complying with the rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 **Marking.**

5.3.1 *Civil agencies.* In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 *Military activities.* In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

## 6. NOTES

6.1 **Intended use.** Handcarts are intended for use in self-service establishments, for conveying food, and small household and similar items.

6.2 **Ordering data.** Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(*a*) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(*b*) Type of handcart (see 1.2.1).
(*c*) Size of handcart (see 1.2.2).
(*d*) Bumpers, when required, and type of material (see 3.2.1).
(*e*) Personalized marking when required (see 3.6).
(*f*) If rear casters are to be swivel type (see 3.2.5).
(*g*) Size of lot, if different from 4.2.1.
(*h*) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(*i*) When handcarts are shipped nested only.

*Preparing activity:*
**GSA-FSS**

*Review activity*:
**Air Force—69**

Review/user information is current as of the date of this document. For future coordination of changes to this document, draft circulation should be based on the information in the current Federal Supply Classification Listing of DOD Standardization Documents.



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